

Migration Readiness Assessment

Answer 25 questions to score your organization's readiness for VMware to KVM migration

25 Questions • 5 Categories • Instant Scoring • Actionable Recommendations

0 / 100

Answer questions below

0 / 25 answered

1 Infrastructure & Environment

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1. How many VMs do you need to migrate?

Total count across all ESXi hosts

1-20

21-50

51-200

201-500

500+

2. What VMware products are you currently running?

More products = more savings potential

ESXi only

ESXi + vCenter

+ vSAN

Full VCF stack

Horizon VDI

3. What is the age of your physical server hardware?

Newer hardware has better KVM support

< 2 years

2-4 years

4-6 years

6+ years

4. Do your servers support hardware virtualization (VT-x/AMD-V)?

Required for KVM

Yes, confirmed

Probably yes (recent HW)

Not sure

No / very old HW

5. What is your primary storage backend?

Affects migration complexity

Local disk (VMFS)

SAN (FC/iSCSI)

vSAN

NFS

Mixed / complex

2 Workload Characteristics

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6. What operating systems run on your VMs?

Linux is easiest, Windows needs VirtIO drivers

Mostly Linux

50/50 Linux/Windows

Mostly Windows

Legacy OS (Win 2008, RHEL 5)

7. Do any VMs require GPU passthrough?

KVM supports GPU passthrough natively

No GPUs

A few GPU VMs

Many GPU VMs (VDI)

Not sure

8. Are there any physical-to-virtual (P2V) appliances?

Vendor appliances may have restrictions

No appliances

A few (firewall, NAS)

Several vendor appliances

Many locked appliances

9. How are your VMs currently backed up?

Backup strategy needs updating post-migration

Veeam / CommVault

VMware-native snapshots

Agent-based (in-guest)

No formal backup

10. What is your maximum acceptable downtime per VM during migration?

Pre-converted VMs: typically 5-15 min cutover

< 15 minutes

1-4 hours

One weekend

Zero downtime required

3 Team & Skills

11. Does your team have Linux administration experience?

KVM runs on Linux — this is the #1 skill

Strong (daily Linux use)

Moderate (some Linux)

Basic (occasional)

None (Windows only)

12. How many people will be on the migration team?

More people = faster migration, but need coordination

1 person

2-3 people

4-6 people

7+ (large team)

13. Is there executive sponsorship for VMware exit?

Critical for budget, timeline, and organizational buy-in

CTO/CIO fully sponsoring

VP/Director supports

Manager level only

No sponsor yet

14. Is your team open to learning new tools (virsh, Ansible)?

Willingness to learn is more important than current skill

Enthusiastic

Willing

Reluctant

Resistant to change

15. Do you have a change management process (CAB, ITIL)?

Structured process reduces risk

Formal ITIL/CAB process

Informal but documented

Ad-hoc

None

4 Business Drivers

16. When does your VMware contract/license expire?

Urgency drives timeline

Already expired

Within 6 months

6-12 months

1-2 years

3+ years remaining

17. How much did your VMware costs increase at last renewal?

Broadcom typically increased 2-5x

No increase

< 50% increase

50-200% increase

200%+ increase

Haven't renewed yet

18. What is your annual VMware licensing spend?

Higher spend = higher savings potential

< \$50K

\$50K-\$150K

\$150K-\$500K

\$500K+

19. Are there compliance requirements (HIPAA, PCI, SOX)?

Compliance adds planning but doesn't block migration

No compliance reqs

SOX

HIPAA or PCI-DSS

Multiple frameworks

Air-gap / classified

20. Is there a strategic direction toward Kubernetes/containers?

KubeVirt enables running VMs + containers on same platform

Already using K8s

Planning K8s adoption

Evaluating

No container plans

5 Risk Tolerance & Timeline

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21. Have you done a POC or tested KVM with any workloads?

Even 1 VM test greatly reduces risk

Yes, successful POC

Tested in lab

Read documentation

No exposure yet

22. What is your target migration timeline?

Faster timelines need more resources

1-3 months

3-6 months

6-12 months

No deadline

23. Do you have a rollback strategy if migration fails?

Keep VMware VMs for 48hr after cutover

Yes, documented rollback

Can keep VMware running

Partial rollback possible

No rollback plan

24. How risk-averse is your organization?

Conservative = more testing phases, slower waves

Risk-tolerant (startup/tech)

Moderate

Conservative (enterprise)

Very risk-averse (regulated)

25. Is there a DR/HA requirement for migrated VMs?

KVM supports Pacemaker HA and Ceph replication

No HA needed

Basic HA (restart on failure)

Full HA + DR site

Active-active required